

Your first automation is two steps long.

If you can write an Excel formula, you can build a Power Automate flow — and it is already sitting in your Microsoft 365. Here is the whole thing: from opening the app to a reminder that sends itself every Monday.

Power Automate

No code

10 minutes

SWIPE →

01

You already write flow logic in Excel.

Every habit on the left already has a twin on the right.

<code>=IF(A1>100,"review","ok")</code>	Condition
The report you send every Monday	Recurrence trigger
XLOOKUP into another sheet	Get items
Copy-pasting it into an email	Send an email (V2)

02

It is already in your Microsoft 365.

The same licence that gives you Outlook and Teams gives you Power Automate. Most people in a corporate Microsoft tenant have had it for years without opening it once.

- 01 Sign in at office.com
- 02 App launcher, top-left — the nine dots
- 03 Power Automate → My flows → New flow

No install. No admin rights. No procurement email.

03

Start at two steps. Nothing more.

One trigger, one action. That is already a complete, legal, working flow. Most abandoned automations were not too hard — they were started too big to ever finish.



That is the entire flow. Ship it, then grow it.

04

Six clicks to a working reminder.

- 01 My flows → New flow → Scheduled cloud flow
- 02 Name it. Repeat every 1 week, on Monday
- 03 Create — the trigger is now done
- 04 New step → search "Send an email (V2)"
- 05 Fill To, Subject, Body. Plain words are fine
- 06 Save → Test → Manually → Run flow

Check your inbox. You just automated something.

05

You do not need to know the syntax.

Nobody memorises Power Automate expressions. Describe what you want in plain language — Copilot sits inside the flow designer, and ChatGPT works just as well in another tab — then paste the answer into the field.

ASK IT LIKE THIS

“In Power Automate, give me an expression for tomorrow's date formatted dd/MM/yyyy.”

If it errors, paste the error back and ask again. That loop is the skill.

06

Watch it run once with your own eyes.

A flow that has never run is still a guess. Hit Test → Manually, then check three things.

- ✓ Did the email actually arrive?
- ✓ Is 09:00 really 09:00 in your timezone?
- ✓ Would you notice if it quietly stopped?

An automation nobody checks is a rumour, not a system.

Three flows worth building first.

01 The Monday nudge

The reminder you retype by hand every week. Recurrence → send email.

02 The deadline warning

An email three days before a due date in your list or spreadsheet.

03 The filing clerk

Save Outlook attachments straight into the right SharePoint folder.

08

Then add one step at a time.

It works. Add a condition — test. Still works. Add a data source — test. Every step you add without testing is a step you will later have to debug blind.

It works

+ one step

Test

It still works

Complexity is fine. Untested complexity is how automations quietly die.

The barrier was never the skill.

It was starting with something too big to finish. A recurrence and an email is small enough to finish today — and everything harder is just that, repeated.

YOUR TURN

Which task do you repeat every single week? Put it in the comments and I will tell you the two steps.

Follow for more field notes on automation, data and AI at work.